Chicken Shawarma Salad

Spiced roast chicken over chopped salad, with two tahini sauces.

SERVES 4 · TOTAL ABOUT 1 HOUR

INGREDIENTS

Shawarma

1 to 1 1/2 lb	boneless, skinless chicken breasts or thighs
1	onion, cut into wedges
1	red bell pepper, in strips (optional)
1 head	cauliflower, in florets (optional)
	olive oil, salt, pepper and lemon zest, for the vegetables

Marinade

1 tsp	kosher salt
2 tsp	ground cumin
2 tsp	ground coriander
1 tsp	ground turmeric
1 tsp	granulated garlic (or 2 cloves, finely minced)
2 tbsp	olive oil

Israeli salad

2	extra-large tomatoes
1	English cucumber
1 cup	red onion (about 1/2 medium)
1	red bell pepper
1	yellow bell pepper
1 cup	fresh herbs: parsley, mint, cilantro or a mix
1	lemon, zested, then juiced to taste (start with half)
1/4 cup	olive oil
	salt and pepper

Tahini yogurt sauce (makes 1 cup)

3/4 cup	plain yogurt, milk kefir or vegan yogurt
1/4 cup	tahini, stirred
1 to 2	garlic cloves, finely minced (or 1/2 tsp granulated)
1/4 to 1/2 tsp	salt, plus more to taste
1/4 tsp	black pepper
1 tsp	lemon juice (optional)
1 tsp	olive oil (optional, for fat-free yogurt)

Green tahini sauce (makes 1 1/2 cups)

1/2 cup	water
2 tbsp	lemon juice
3 tbsp	olive oil
2 large	garlic cloves
3/4 cup	fresh herbs: cilantro, parsley, mint, dill or basil
2 to 3 slices	jalapeño (optional)
1/2 to 1 tsp	salt, starting with 1/2 tsp
1/2 cup	tahini, stirred

To serve

	greens, such as arugula or spinach
	quick-pickled onions and warm pita (optional)

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to **400F (205C)** and line a large sheet pan with parchment. Whisk the marinade ingredients together in a small bowl.

2. Lay the chicken and vegetables on the pan, keeping them apart. Brush the chicken heavily with marinade. Dress the vegetables with olive oil, salt, pepper and a little lemon zest, or with any marinade left over.

3. Roast and check at **20 minutes**; breasts finish before thighs. Toss the vegetables and keep roasting until the chicken is cooked through, **165F (74C)** inside, and the vegetables are tender, **20 to 30 minutes** in all.

4. While it roasts, make the salad. Cut the tomatoes, cucumber, onion and both peppers into a very small, even dice; the finer the cut, the better the salad, so use your sharpest knife. Chop the herbs and toss everything with the zest, olive oil, half the lemon's juice, salt and pepper. Taste: if it seems flat, it usually wants more salt, then more lemon.

5. Tahini yogurt: whisk the yogurt, tahini, garlic, salt and pepper until completely smooth. Add the lemon juice only if your yogurt isn't tangy; with fat-free yogurt, add the olive oil or a little extra tahini for richness. Refrigerate until serving.

6. Green tahini: blend everything except the tahini until combined but still a little rough. It will look far too thin; add the tahini and blend until creamy and it thickens, leaving flecks of herb. Adjust salt, lemon and chile, and loosen with water if needed.

7. Slice the chicken. Spoon a little sauce onto each plate, pile on greens and the Israeli salad, then top with the chicken, roasted vegetables and pickled onions. Drizzle with either sauce or both, with warm pita alongside.

NOTES

- Make ahead: the chicken can sit in the marinade, sealed, for up to **48 hours**. Cooked shawarma keeps **4 days** in the fridge or **3 months** frozen; reheat in a warm oven or a skillet.
- Watery salad: salt the diced cucumber and tomato and drain in a colander for **30 minutes** before mixing. The salad keeps **3 to 4 days** but is best in the first two.
- Sauces keep: tahini yogurt **4 days** (longer made with granulated garlic); green tahini **5 days** in a sealed jar. A spoonful or two of za'atar is a good addition to the green sauce. For an oil-free version, swap the oil for water and a little more tahini.
- Swaps: tofu can share the pan and needs the full **30 minutes** to crust. Shrimp cooks fast; add it only once the vegetables are nearly done, or sear it in the marinade in a skillet. Readers often double the marinade.
- Wraps or bowls instead: tuck everything into warm 10 to 12 in wraps, or serve over rice or quinoa. For low-carb bowls, roast riced cauliflower on a second pan with olive oil, salt, pepper, lemon zest and a pinch of cumin, tossing every **10 minutes** until crisp in spots.

PER SERVING

Shawarma bowl (chicken breast, riced cauliflower, no sauce): 380 cal, 50.5 g protein, 15.2 g carbs, 13.2 g fat. Israeli salad: 83 cal per cup. Per 2 tbsp: tahini yogurt 76 cal, green tahini 95 cal.

SUMAC, TAHINI & PRESERVED LEMON
PROTEIN MAIN · SHEET PAN, 400F (205C)
EGYPT

Adapted from Sylvia Fountaine, Feasting at Home (feastingathome.com): Sheet Pan Shawarma, Israeli Salad, Tahini Yogurt Sauce and Green Tahini Sauce. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.